Merek Soriano

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EDUCATION

Cornell University, College of Engineering, Ithaca, NY Expected May 2027
Bachelor of Science, Operations Research and Information Engineering; Minor in Artificial Intelligence
22 credits in Spring 2026 | Relevant Coursework: Optimization Methods, Machine Learning & Data Science
Admitted: M.Eng., ORIE (Data Analytics concentration), Spring 2027 - Dec 2027

WORK EXPERIENCE

American Electric Power, *Columbus, OH* Jun 2026 - Aug 2026
Business Process Improvement and AI Intern

- Built AI document intelligence pipelines, including an embedding and clustering pipeline that turned ~2,500 construction change orders into 10 actionable process improvement themes, rerunnable on any new batch.
- Built a dual-pass LLM extraction tool for the procurement team that pulls order details from vendor PDFs and scans with no per-vendor templates, routing disagreements to human review and cutting processing from days to minutes.
- Led a robotics investment study for a Vice President-level executive, scoring 48 use cases on a four-part rubric to surface 6 priorities with business cases, earning leadership buy-in for a multi-year initiative.

Secretariat International, *El Segundo, CA* Jun 2025 - Aug 2025
Construction Delay Consulting Intern

- Conducted critical path and delay analysis across 4 multi-million-dollar construction projects using Primavera P6, building schedule models that quantified timeline impacts and supported client settlement valuations.
- Engineered data extraction and integration workflows to consolidate project data from multiple sources, developing analytical frameworks to support expert testimony and mediation proceedings.

Student Agencies, *Ithaca, NY* Feb 2024 - Aug 2024
Operations Manager

- Led cross-functional operations for 80+ employees, scaling revenue to $375K annually with 10% YoY growth.
- Implemented algorithmic route optimization and scheduling, achieving 100% on-time delivery performance across 10+ concurrent relocation projects.
- Architected and deployed a Salesforce-based billing and logistics platform serving 1,000+ customers across two warehouses, engineering automated workflows to streamline operations and improve cash flow management.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE & ACTIVITIES

Cornell Generative AI Club, *Ithaca, NY* Feb 2025 - Present
Founding Head of Corporate Partnerships

- Secured and delivered AI consulting engagements through partnerships with 10+ firms, leading projects from client discovery to deployment; scaled the business team from 12 to 30+ members.

PROJECTS

ALICE: Edge AI Agent Governance (Best Design, DN Hacks 2026) Sep 2026
Owned backend integration on a 5-person team. Edge system (Raspberry Pi, ESP32, Python, FastAPI, React) governing AI agent actions when enterprise connectivity is lost; on-device anomaly scoring routes risky actions to a biometrically verified technician.

PCCW Mentor-Mentee Matching Algorithm Jan 2026 - May 2026
Production mentor-matching system (Next.js, TypeScript, Python, Supabase PostgreSQL) with three selectable algorithms and a 153-test evaluation harness; automated pairing, eliminating 40+ labor hours per semester.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

AI & Engineering: LLM APIs (Claude, OpenAI), Embeddings & Clustering, Agent Orchestration (LangGraph), REST APIs (FastAPI)
Software: Python, TypeScript, React, Next.js, PostgreSQL, Docker
Data & Business Tools: SQL, Excel (Advanced Modeling), Tableau, Salesforce
Interests: Applied AI in Operations, Off-Grid Hiking, Snowboarding, Basketball